

Risk Assessment No: WP-011				Task: Confined Space Entry — Thickener, Sumps, Buffer Tanks & Hoppers							
Prepared By: Derick Bibby				Date: 02.08.2026			RA Review Date: 01.08.2027				
				Reviewed By: Lee Hardy			Date: 02.08.2026				
PPE: Safety Footwear, High Visibility Jacket, High Visibility Trousers, Hard Hat, Gloves, Ear Defenders, Mask, Eye Protection											
Hazard	Persons at Risk	L	S	R	Control Measures				L	S	R
Hazardous atmosphere — O ₂ deficiency, H ₂ S, CO, flammable vapour	Entrant Top-man	3	5	15	- Confined Space Permit issued only after atmosphere test at multiple depths. - Continuous multi-gas monitor worn by entrant; alarms set to statutory thresholds. - Forced-air ventilation as required by the permit. - Rescue plan documented and communicated before entry; rescue equipment rigged.				1	5	5
Engulfment by slurry, water, fines or filter cake	Entrant	3	5	15	- Full LOTO of all inflows (feed, flocculant, water, pumps) before entry. - Physical isolation (line-blank, spade or double-block-and-bleed) where slip through a valve is credible. - Never enter a partially drained tank until proved gas-free and physically isolated. - Entry point sized to allow rescue retrieval.				1	5	5
Failed rescue / entrapment of entrant	Entrant	2	5	10	- Rescue tripod and winch rigged at entry point before any breaking of containment. - Top-man in continuous visual/voice contact; radio channel dedicated to entry. - Standby rescue team briefed and equipped before permit signed. - No entry without pre-agreed rescue plan and drill within last 12 months.				1	5	5
Failure of isolation — incomplete LOTO leading to re-energisation	Maintenance Contractors	3	5	15	- Every energy source (electrical, hydraulic, pneumatic, water, gravitational, stored) individually locked with the operator's personal padlock and tagged. - Zero-energy proved by attempted start and gauge/meter verification. - Only the lock-owner may remove their lock — Lock Removal Procedure signed by SHEQ Manager if unavailable. - LOTO station stocked and audited monthly.				1	5	5
Chemical exposure — flocculant, lubricants, coolants, hydraulic fluid	Maintenance Operator	3	3	9	- COSHH assessment for every chemical on site; SDS held at MCC and maintenance office. - Chemical-resistant gloves and eye/face protection during handling and dosing. - Bunded storage; spill kits at each storage point. - Emergency eyewash station at MCC and picking station. - Waste chemicals disposed via licensed contractor; consignment notes retained.				1	3	3
Lone working during	Operator	3	4	12	Lone-worker device or hourly radio/phone check-in with supervisor.				1	4	4

out-of-hours starts, wash-downs or fault- finding	Maintenance				• No high-risk task (work at height, confined space, hot works) performed alone. • Radio and mobile signal verified across plant footprint. • Emergency contact list posted at MCC and welfare unit.			
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